

**MODERNIZING THE H-2A
PROGRAM FOR A
RESILIENT AGRICULTURAL
ECONOMY**



PART I. H-2A POLICY

- WHAT IS H-2A
- HOW IT WORKS
- THE NECESSITY AND ECONOMIC REALITY OF H-2A

WHAT IS H-2A?

- **Definition:** A federal program allowing U.S. agricultural employers to hire foreign nationals for **temporary or seasonal** labor.
- **The Goal:** To fill a critical manual labor gap that domestic workers are unable or unwilling to fill.
- **The Scope:** It is the fastest-growing visa program in the U.S., tripling in size over the last 10 years to meet domestic demand (Costa & Zipperer, 2024).

HOW IT WORKS

- **Step 1: The "Market Test" (Recruitment)**
- **Step 2: Department of Labor (DOL) Certification**
- **Step 3: The "Premium" Commitment**
- **Step 4: Visa Issuance & Arrival**

THE NECESSITY AND ECONOMIC REALITY OF H-2A

- A "Necessary Evil":
- H-2A serves as a critical safety valve for a domestic labor shortage.
- The Price of Necessity:
- When a program is built out of desperation, humanitarian and economic standards often suffer.



PART III. STAKEHOLDERS

- Farmers
- Immigrant Workers
- Domestic U.S Workers
- Consumers

THE FARMERS' BURDEN

THE WORKERS' REALITY

IMMIGRANT WORKERS



FARMERS



FARMERS

DOMESTIC U.S WORKERS

CONSUMERS



PART IV. POLICY EVALUATION

- Efficiency and effectiveness
- Who is the winner
- Dynamic Effect



PART V. POLICY IMPROVEMENT STRATEGIES

- Improve the current system
- Reduce reliance on the system
- Replace the system

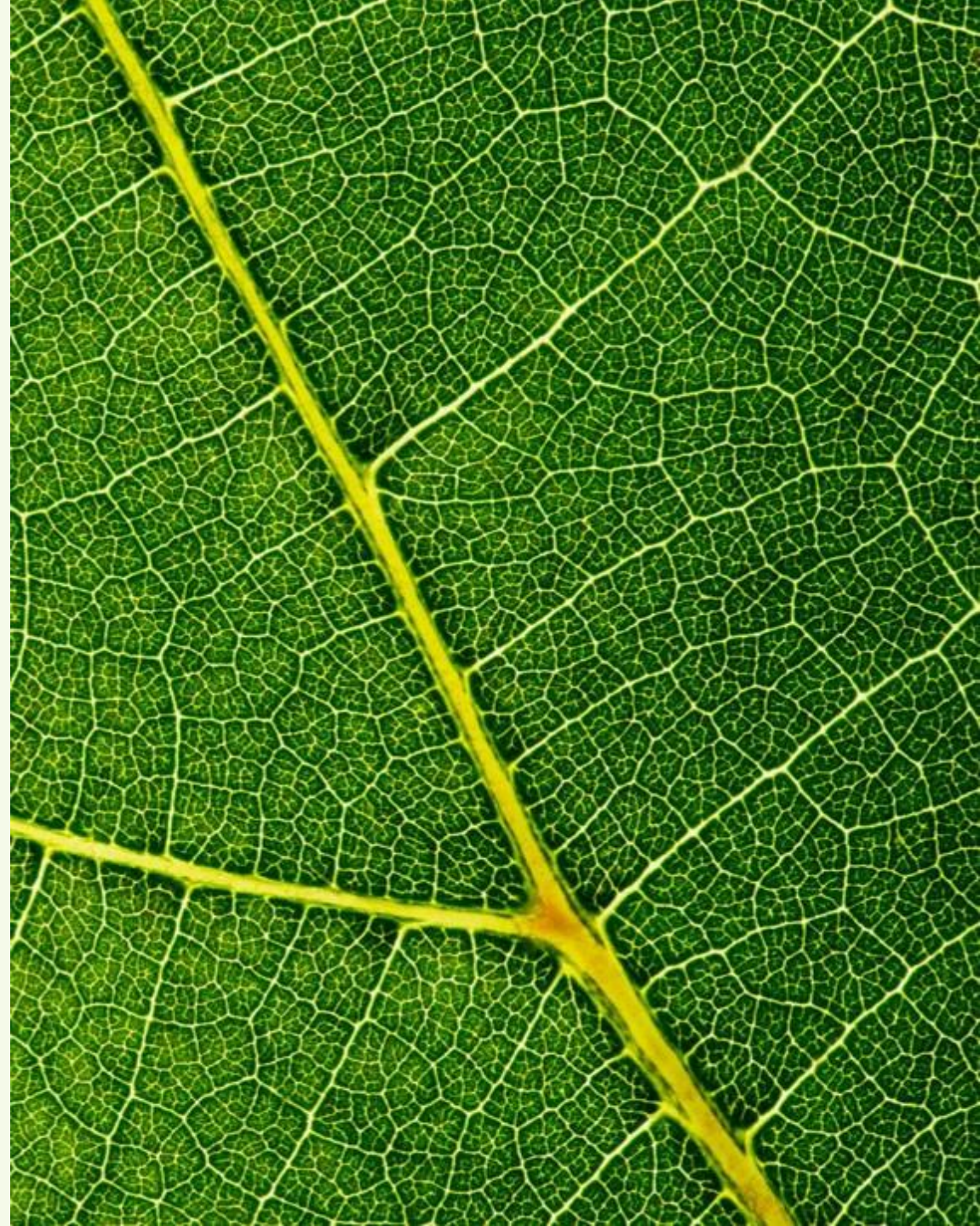
THANK YOU

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THE CONSUMER AND THE MARKET



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